

Avoiding Stress Spillover

It's easy to let stress or frustration bleed into an email or a comment in a meeting. This practice keeps that from happening.

The Rule

1 Before Speaking, 3 Before Sending

When you feel stressed, frustrated, or keyed up:

- ✓ Take **one breath** before speaking.
- ✓ Take **three breaths** before sending an email.

Why one vs. three?

In a live conversation, a one-breath pause is discreet. Three might seem odd.

With email, you have privacy to take longer. Plus, email leaves a record, so it's worth taking the extra time.